

Installing Python & VS Code

Why Proper Setup Matters

Before writing any code, it is important to set up the right tools. A correct Python and editor setup ensures a smooth learning experience and avoids common beginner issues.

Installing Python

Python is the language we will use for all data analytics tasks.

In this section, you will learn:

- How to download and install Python
- How to verify that Python is installed correctly
- Understanding the Python version and basic setup

Python is available for Windows, macOS, and Linux. Always install the **latest stable version** from the official website.

Installation

1. Open your browser and go to <https://www.python.org>
2. Click on **Downloads** and download the **latest Python version for Windows** (this will download a .exe installer).
3. Once the download is complete, **double-click the installer** to start the setup.
4. On the first setup screen, **check the box** that says **“Add Python to PATH”** (this step is very important).
5. Click on **Install Now**.
6. The installer will begin installing Python on your system. This may take a few minutes.
7. When the installation is complete, click **Close**.
8. To make sure everything works correctly, open **Command Prompt** or **Terminal** and run:
9. `python --version`
10. If Python is installed successfully, you will see the installed Python version displayed.

Your Python installation is now complete and ready to use.

Installing Visual Studio Code

Visual Studio Code is a lightweight and powerful code editor widely used by data analysts and developers.

You will learn:

- How to install VS Code
- Setting up Python support in VS Code
- Running Python files inside the editor

Installation

1. Go to <https://code.visualstudio.com>
2. Click **Download**
3. Choose your operating system
4. Download the installer
5. Run the installer
6. Accept the agreement
7. **Check these options:**
 - Add "Open with Code" action to Windows Explorer file context menu
 - Add "Open with Code" action to Windows Explorer directory context menu
 - Register Code as an editor for supported file types
 - Add to PATH
8. Click **Install**
9. Once the installation is complete, click **Finish** to launch VS Code.

And that's it! You have both Python and VS Code installed and ready to use.